

Minutes of the Regular Meeting of May 18, 2022

The Board of Education of Community Unit School District No. 1, Coles and Cumberland Counties, Illinois met in regular session on Wednesday, May 18, 2022 at the Administration Office – 410 West Polk Avenue, Charleston, Illinois 61920.

At 6:30 p.m., President Coe called the meeting to order and asked Secretary Daniels for roll call.

The following board members were present:

Jason Coe, President
Scott Clarke, Vice President
Susan Daniels, Secretary
Charles Jarrell, Treasurer
Brian Gough
Eva Ritchey
Brandon Wright

The following staff members were present:

Todd Vilardo, Superintendent of Schools
Chad Burgett, Assistant Superintendent for Business Services
Kristen Holly, Assistant Superintendent for Student Services
Genia Lang, Recording Secretary

Visitors 25 and 0 Members of the Press

Under Focus on Students and Good News Reports, Artwork Display provided by the students in Jefferson Elementary School in grades 4 - 6. Art teacher – Mandy White

Charleston High School

Principal Aaron Lock recognized the following students from the graduating Class of 2022, for their individual athletic success while representing the Charleston Trojans during the winter season.

- **Jaksen Braun** – Boys' Basketball – Sectional 3-point competition qualifier, 3rd Team 3A IBCA All-State Team
- **Addy Logsdon** – Girls' Basketball – Sectional 3-point competition qualifier
- **Hannah Taylor** – Trojans – State finalist for solo routine, 6th place finish
- **Maddi Bryant** – Wrestling – 3rd place in sectionals, qualifying for first ever Girls' State competition

CBE Pilot Teachers

Assistant Superintendent for Student Services Kristen Holly recognized the Competency Based Education (CBE) Pilot Teachers from 2019-2020 and 2020-2022 for or their work over the past 3-years to implement CBE instructional practices in their classrooms. Mrs. Holly stated that there are 43 pilot teachers who represent all grades PK-12 and serve throughout all 6 district schools. The teachers volunteered to participate in the pilot, with the understanding that they would serve as leaders for their colleagues as we make the transition to Competency Based Education. Pilot teachers from 2019-20: Debbie Oakley, Laura Decker, Christina Coffey, Jennifer Evans, Paige Harrington, Justin Bledsaw, Cindy Goodchild, and Kelly Rice, Pilot Teachers from 2021-22: Amber Dennis, Amanda Gentry, Ashley Hernandez, Aimee Repking, Kendra Barker, Amanda Craig, Tamara Delude, Jessica Coffman, Theresa Ehr, Kim Spanhook, Jennifer Peterson, Jeremy Hudson, and Angel Warman.

Under Public, Staff Comments, Written Communication, President Coe asked if there were any requests or written communications to the Board of Education. No requests were received.

Dr. Vilardo reported that during the Board of Education Retreat held on July 28, facilitator Jim Burgett made the suggestion that was met favorably by our Board to address one standard or principle from the Code of Conduct at each regular Board meeting. Board President Jason Coe read the 9th principle and definition from the Code of Conduct.

Under the Consent Agenda, President Coe asked if there were board members who would like any of the consent agenda items pulled for discussion in closed session. No requests were received.

Dr. Vilardo reviewed the items under Consent Agenda.

Consent Agenda: Standard Items

- Approve the minutes of the Regular Meeting of April 20, 2022.
- Approve the bills and payrolls for the month of April 2022.
- Approve the Activity Fund Accounts for the CUSD #1 attendance centers, period ending April 2022.
- Approve the summary of revenues and expenditures year to date for the period ending April 2022, as presented by Assistant Superintendent Chad Burgett.

Consent Agenda: New Business

- Adopt the School Behavior Notice and elementary, middle and high school handbooks for the 2022-23 school year as presented.
- Approve the Workload Plan for Special Educators as presented.
- Accept the Agreements for Case Study Evaluation Testing between Charleston Community Unit School District No. 1 and Summer Testing Employees, (Social Worker Deena Ballard, School Psychologist Cheryl Armstrong, and Speech/Language Pathologist Jana Sweeney) for the purpose of completing case study evaluations of students during the summer of 2022.
- Approve a contractual agreement with Jana Sweeney to provide part-time assistance in completing Early Childhood Speech/Language evaluations during the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the contractual agreements with Rita McCollum and Cheryl Armstrong to serve as School Psychologists for the 2022-23 school year, not to exceed 100 days each.
- Approve a consultant agreement with Mara Hildebrand to provide part-time assistance as the District IEP Medical Review Registered Nurse during the 2022-23 school year.

Consent Agenda: Employment

- Accept a letter of resignation from Holly Williams as District Director of Educational Technology, effective June 30, 2022.
- Accept a letter of resignation from Jessica Rodriguez as an 8th grade English Language Arts teacher at Charleston Middle School, effective at the end of the 2021-22 school year.
- Accept a letter of resignation from Carey Dwyer as a School Social Worker at Mark Twain Elementary School, effective at the end of the 2021-22 school year.
- Accept a letter of resignation from Knovelle McClain as a paraprofessional at Mark Twain Elementary School, effective at the end of the 2021-22 school year.

- Accept a letter of resignation from Andrew Alexander as the Varsity Assistant Boys' Basketball Coach at Charleston High School, effective April 20, 2022.
- Accept a letter of resignation from Justin Gunther as the Assistant Girls' Basketball Coach at Charleston High School, effective immediately.
- Accept a letter of resignation from Doug Kanouse as the 7th grade Boys' Track Coach at Charleston Middle School, effective at the end of the track season.
- Approve the voluntary transfer of John Belleau into the position as an English Language Arts teacher at Charleston High School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the voluntary transfer of Eric Mueller into the position as a Band Educator at Jefferson Elementary School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the voluntary transfer of Hannah Hudson into the position as an Interventionist at Carl Sandburg Elementary School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the voluntary transfer of Lauren Hennig into the position as a 4th grade teacher at Ashmore Elementary School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the voluntary transfer of Brittany Schwenke into the position as a full-time School Healthcare Professional, beginning with the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the increase in Charleston High School's art teaching position from a part-time to a full-time position and place Heather Siegel on the Professional Negotiations Agreement salary schedule accordingly for the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the employment of Paige Scamihorn in the position as a Social Science teacher at Charleston High School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the employment of Shani Weiss in the position as a Physical Education teacher at Charleston High School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the employment of Holly Williams in the position as a District Instructional Technology Coach, beginning with the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the employment of Annie Lopez in the position as a English Learner Instructor/Interventionist for the District, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the employment of Ashley Oliver in the position as an English Language Arts teacher (assigned to 8th grade) at Charleston Middle School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the employment of Lindsay Babcock in the position as an LBS1 teacher at Jefferson Elementary School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the employment of Kayci Coulibaly in the position as a classroom teacher (assigned to 6th grade) at Jefferson Elementary School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.

- Approve the employment of Megan Fisher in the position as a classroom teacher (assigned to 6th grade) at Jefferson Elementary School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the employment of Ashlyn Hudson in the position as a classroom teacher (assigned to 1st grade) at Carl Sandburg Elementary School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the employment of Samantha Rogers in the position as a classroom teacher (assigned to 3rd grade) at Carl Sandburg Elementary School, beginning with the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the employment of Colin McInerney in the extra-curricular assignment as the Assistant Boys' Basketball Coach at Charleston High School during the 2022-23 school year.
- Approve the employment of Shani Weiss in the extra-curricular assignment as the Head Girls' Basketball Coach at Charleston High School during the 2022-23 school year. This employment was contingent upon the receipt of all information required for employment.
- Approve the recommendation for Charlie Logsdon to serve as a volunteer football coach at Charleston High School during the 2022-23 school year, contingent upon the receipt of all required paperwork.
- Approve the list of substitutes and volunteers, effective May 2022.

President Coe recommended that the Board of Education approve items under IV through VII inclusive on the Consent Agenda. Dr. Clarke moved and Mrs. Ritchey seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Clarke, Ritchey, Gough, Jarrell, Wright, Daniels, Coe

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Under the Superintendent's Report: CUSD #1 On-Line Registration Update

Dr. Vilardo announced that the District will again utilize an online school registration system for the 2022-23 school year. District staff are planning to make the online registration process available on July 6 this year, and online registration assistance will be by appointment only with district secretarial staff. CUSD#1 families will receive email and text notifications with a registration checklist and specific information about changes to this process. Families will be asked to complete registration by August 5, 2022 to allow schools time to finalize class lists/student schedules. August 18 is the first day of student attendance.

Pre-school Screening/Kindergarten Registration

Project H.E.L.P. and the Charleston School District offered pre-school screenings and Kindergarten Roundup in Charleston at Mark Twain Elementary School on February 22-24, 2022 and at Ashmore Elementary School on March 22. Screenings consisted of 129 preschool age children, 72 younger than preschool age, and 47 upcoming Kindergarten students. "1st Step" Registration for Mark Twain incoming students is on-line and opened on May 2. Currently, 92 students have registered in 1st Step.

Excellence in Education Foundation Grant Recipients

Dr. Vilardo announced that the Excellence in Education Foundation awarded over \$27,000 in grants this year. Grant recipients may be recognized on August 17 during the All-Staff Institute Day at Charleston High School, contingent upon Swickard Auditorium renovation readiness.

CUSD #1 Facilities Update

Dr. Vilardo reported that through the County Schools Facilities Tax, Charleston CUSD #1 continues to utilize a collaborative process of reviewing, prioritizing, and pursuing facilities needs and improvements. Mr. Burgett provided a report on the projects underway throughout the district and estimated completion dates.

Update/Plan for Safe Return to In-Person Instruction and Continuity of Services

The Board has expressed an interest in receiving monthly updates about COVID-19 pandemic planning, mitigations, effects, and responses. Dr. Vilardo reported that no changes to our plan have been made since its March 9, 2022 update.

Mr. Jarrell moved and Mr. Wright seconded a motion that the Superintendent's Report was received by the Board of Education.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Jarrell, Wright, Clarke, Gough, Ritchey, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Under New Business: Award Proposal – Diesel Fuel Bid 2022-2023 School Year

On May 9, 2022, the district accepted sealed bids for diesel fuel for school bus transportation purposes for the 2022-23 school year. The district received two (2) bid proposals: The Equity, Inc., Effingham, Illinois and Bolin Transport, LLC, Casey, Illinois. It was the recommendation of the superintendent that the Board of Education award the contract to provide B5 SME BIODIESEL diesel fuel for school bus transportation purposes to The Equity of Effingham, Illinois for the 2022-2023 school year. Dr. Clarke moved and Mrs. Ritchey seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Clarke, Ritchey, Gough, Jarrell, Wright, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Amendment to CUSD #1 2021-22 Budget/Establish Date & Time for Budget Hearing

When a school district has a total disbursement in a fund that is greater than the amount budgeted for any year, the district is required to make an amendment to the budget. Assistant Superintendent for Business Services Chad Burgett reported that after review of current expenditures for the district adjustments are being recommended for the 2021-22 budget. He outlined the recommended adjustments that will need to be adopted at the June 15, 2022 board meeting. The amended budget will be on file and available for public inspection for the required 30 days at the Office of the Superintendent of Schools. A public hearing on the amended budget will be held at 6:15pm on June 15, 2022 with final adoption following the hearing.

It was the recommendation of the superintendent that the Board of Education review the amendment to the 2021-22 school district budget pending a public hearing on the amended budget to be held on Wednesday, June 15, 2022 at 6:15pm. Mr. Jarrell moved and Mrs. Ritchey seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Jarrell, Ritchey, Clarke, Gough, Wright, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Establish Wage Schedule for Part-Time Employees and Substitutes 2022-23

The school district employs several people in part-time positions and, also needs to employ substitutes when current employees must miss work. Board members were provided with a compensation proposal for part-time and substitute positions for consideration. Assistant Superintendent Burgett reported that increases will meet the January 1, 2023 minimum wage requirement of \$13.00 per hour. This year's wage schedule includes Driver's Ed Behind Wheel Sub Position pay at \$28.00 per hour. The substitute teacher rate of pay has been increased to \$110.00 per day.

It was the recommendation of the superintendent that that Board of Education to approve a proposed wage schedule for part time and substitute employees, effective July 1, 2022. Dr. Clarke moved and Mr. Wright seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Clarke, Wright, Gough, Jarrell, Ritchey, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Student Fees/Charges for 2022-23 School Year

The schedule for Student Fees/Charges and Activity Participation Fee Schedule for the 2022-23 school year was presented to the Board of Education for consideration. Mr. Burgett reported that the schedule has been updated to reflect a decrease in the CHS parking fee to \$25.00 and all other fees will remain the same. The district will continue to provide school time insurance coverage on all students attending Charleston CUSD #1. It will remain up to the parents to enroll their student(s) for full time coverage with the selected insurance agency.

It was the recommendation of the superintendent that the Board of Education establish the 2022-23 Student Fees/Charges Schedule and Activity Participation Fee Schedule as presented. Mr. Jarrell moved and Dr. Clarke seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Jarrell, Clarke, Gough, Ritchey, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Mr. Wright – left the room prior to vote

Motion carried

Proposed Job Description/Technology Instructional Coach Position (1st reading)

According to Board Policy 5:30, the Superintendent is to develop and maintain a current comprehensive job description for each position or job category. With the implementation of Competency Based Education and the most recent need to support student learning loss an Instructional Technology Coach will provide essential professional development for teachers. It was the recommendation of the superintendent that the Board of Education adopt, in tentative form, a job description for the position of Instructional Technology Coach on first reading. The tentative job description will be placed for public review until final adoption at the June 15, 2022 board meeting. Mr. Gough moved and Mrs. Ritchey seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Gough, Ritchey, Clarke, Jarrell, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Mr. Wright – left the room prior to vote

Motion carried

Adoption/English Language Arts Curriculum Maps K-12

The K-12 English Language Arts teachers have been working together for the past two years to revise the district ELA curriculum to align with Competency Based Education. Based on the recommendation of the Elementary Curriculum Council, Secondary Curriculum Council, and Assistant Superintendent Kristen Holly, the superintendent recommended that the Board of Education adopt the K-12 English Language Arts Curriculum as presented to be implemented beginning in the 2022-2023 school year. Mr. Wright moved and Dr. Clarke seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Wright, Clarke, Gough, Jarrell, Ritchey, Coe

NAY: none Abstain: Daniels

Motion carried

Adoption/Math Curriculum Maps K-12

The K-12 math teachers have been working together for the past three years to revise the district math curriculum to align with Competency Based Education. Based on the recommendation of the Elementary Curriculum Council, Secondary Curriculum Council, and Assistant Superintendent Kristen Holly, the superintendent recommended that the Board of Education adopt the K-12 Math Curriculum as presented to be implemented beginning in the 2022-2023 school year. Mr. Jarrell moved and Mr. Wright seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Jarrell, Wright, Clarke, Gough, Ritchey, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Adoption/English Language Arts Textbook 6-12

Teachers in grades PK-12 have been previewing and piloting materials to support their reading, writing and word study instruction to ensure that they have a program that will be the best fit with Competency Based Education (CBE) and aligns with the newly developed proficiency scales. Based on the recommendation of the Elementary Curriculum Council, Secondary Curriculum Council, and Assistant Superintendent Kristen Holly, the superintendent recommended that the Board of Education approve the adoption of the MyPerspectives textbook series, published by SAVVAS for Grades 6-12 English Language Arts instruction. Dr. Clarke moved and Mr. Jarrell seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Clarke, Jarrell, Gough, Ritchey, Wright, Coe

NAY: none Abstain: Daniels

Motion carried

Retraction of Resolution Reference to Dismiss Six (6) Educational Support Professional Employees

Dr. Vilardo reported that at its April 20, 2022 meeting, the Board of Education took action to honorably dismiss six Educational Support Professionals for the 2022-2023 school year due to a Reduction in Force. Soon after, it was brought to his attention that some of the employees should not have been honorably dismissed because they were employed prior to other Educational Support Professionals who, instead, should have been honorably dismissed. Upon confirming this, Dr. Vilardo immediately contacted ESPA President Marilyn Ferguson and the impacted employees to explain and apologize for the error. Since then, and as has historically been the case from year to year, all employees who were honorably dismissed do have the opportunity to remain employed for the 2022-23 school year.

It was the recommendation of the superintendent that the Board of Education retract the Resolution for the Honorable Dismissal or Reduction of the Educational Support Professionals listed to correct the error and record the correction in the impacted employee's personnel files, a retraction of the honorable dismissals was necessary for the following employees:

Jennifer Murphy – Paraprofessional, Mark Twain Elementary School
Valerie Rubin –Paraprofessional, Mark Twain Elementary School
Missy Brown –Paraprofessional, Jefferson Elementary School
Ashley Oliver –Paraprofessional, Charleston Middle School

Further, that the Board of Education approve the sending of written notice of this retraction and make record of the correction in these employee's personnel files. Mr. Jarrell moved and Mrs. Ritchey seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Jarrell, Ritchey, Clarke, Gough, Wright, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Ratification of the Professional Negotiations Agreement 2022-2025, CEA

The Professional Negotiations Agreement between the Charleston Education Association, IEA/NEA, and the Charleston Board of Education expires August 15, 2022. Dr. Vilardo announced that with successful bargaining sessions and working together to find the best solutions, a tentative agreement was reached on March 31, 2022. On Thursday, April 28, 2022, the Charleston Education Association met with its membership to review and vote on the 2022-2025 collective bargaining agreement. CEA President Angel Warman reported that the association ratified the contract by a 93-22 vote. It was the recommendation of the superintendent that the Board of Education ratify the Professional Negotiations Agreement for the years 2022-2025 between the Charleston Education Association, IEA/NEA and the Charleston Board of Education. Mr. Jarrell moved and Mrs. Ritchey seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Jarrell, Ritchey, Clarke, Gough, Wright, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Ratification of the Professional Negotiations Agreement 2022-2026, CESP

The Professional Negotiations Agreement between the Charleston Educational Support Professional Association, IEA/NEA, and the Charleston Board of Education expires June 30, 2022. Dr. Vilardo announced that with successful bargaining sessions and working together to find the best solutions, a tentative agreement was reached on May 9, 2022. On Thursday, May 12, 2022, the Charleston Educational Support Professional Association met with its membership to review and vote on the 2022-2026 collective bargaining agreement. CESP President Marilyn Ferguson reported that the association ratified the contract by a 26-0 vote. It was the recommendation of the superintendent that the Board of Education ratify the Professional Negotiations Agreement for the years 2022-2026 between the Charleston Educational Support Professional Association, IEA/NEA and the Charleston Board of Education. Dr. Clarke moved and Mrs. Ritchey seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Clarke, Ritchey, Gough, Jarrell, Wright, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Employment/Carl Sandburg Elementary School Assistant Principal, effective July 1, 2022

The process to hire the Assistant Principal for Carl Sandburg Elementary School was used as in the past administrative positions. The applications were screened with a rubric by a screening committee to determine the candidates to be brought to the interviews. Team interviews were held with four (4) potential candidates on April 23, 2022. It was the recommendation of the superintendent that the Board of Education approve a one-year, 10-month performance based administrative contract with Beth Anne Morgan to be employed as the Assistant Principal for Carl Sandburg Elementary School, beginning July 1, 2022, (press release located in official board book). Mrs. Ritchey moved and Dr. Clarke seconded the motion.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Ritchey, Clarke, Gough, Jarrell, Wright, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

At 7:48pm, Mr. Jarrell moved and Mrs. Ritchey seconded the motion to adjourn from the Regular Board meeting.

On roll call vote:

AYE: Jarrell, Ritchey, Clarke, Gough, Wright, Coe, Daniels

NAY: none Abstain: none

Motion carried

Scott Clarke

President Pro-Tem, Board of Education

Susan Daniels

Secretary, Board of Education